

Buying in Durrës: prices, taxes, steps

A guide for foreign buyers, September 2026. Prices are what sellers ask on Domlivo as of September 20, 2026; fees, taxes and procedures come from the Domlivo research base with their sources and confidence notes. Nothing here is legal advice — the open points are marked, and a notary or lawyer in Albania is the last word on your own contract.

Who this guide is for

You are looking at a flat in Durrës or on its coast — Golem, Plazh, Shkëmbi i Kavajës, Qerret, Mali i Robit or the Bay of Lalëz — and you do not live in Albania. Most buyers here come from Kosovo, the Czech Republic, Poland, Hungary, Germany and Switzerland (often the Albanian diaspora), Italy and Ukraine, with a budget of roughly €50,000–150,000 and a plan to combine summer use with letting. You want to know what things cost, what the purchase adds on top of the price, which papers to bring, and what to check before any money moves. That is what the next pages cover, in that order.

Durrës in one page

Durrës is Albania's main port (about 80% of the country's foreign trade goes through it), a university town of some 150,000 people, and the beach most of Tirana drives to. Its property market is the cheapest coastal entry in the country and the one with the broadest foreign demand — Century 21 put foreigners at about half of coastal buyers in 2026 (monitor.al). Two things shape it: the November 2019 earthquake (M6.4, epicentre near the city), which left a lasting premium on new construction and a discount on old stock in Plazh and Shkëmbi i Kavajës; and the Tirana–Durrës–airport railway, promised for 2027 after repeated delays, which would put the city 22 minutes from the capital.

City centre, Vollga and Currila. The old town, the seafront promenade and the hill above it. New towers near the port ask more than €2,500/m² (monitor.al, April 2026); the research base's working range for the centre is €900–1,500/m² and for Vollga €1,000–1,800/m². Demand is local families and Tirana commuters, so it lets year-round. On Domlivo, [City Centre](#) has 46 flats for sale, median €1,500/m².

Plazh (Iliria, Hekurudha, Pelikan). The city's mass beach strip. Most of the stock is more than 30 years old; monitor.al quotes €1,200–1,700/m² in 2026, and €2,000/m² applies to roughly 5% of new first-line units. Gross short-let yields of 7–11% (Investropa) are the best on the coast, but the season is short. [Plazh on Domlivo](#): 66 flats, median €1,588/m².

Shkëmbi i Kavajës. The rocky headland south of Plazh: new builds at €1,200–2,000/m², old resale at €450–800/m² (monitor.al, indomio.al). A pure summer market that goes quiet in winter. [Shkëmbi on Domlivo](#): 30 flats, median €1,471/m².

Golem. The long pine-backed beach with the most Kosovar and diaspora owners. Second and third lines ask €1,100–1,500/m², the first line €2,000–2,500/m² with no new construction (monitor.al). Two honest caveats: sewage discharges onto the beach have been documented repeatedly and the World Bank works are not finished, and the short-let market runs from May to September — January occupancy is about 13%. [Golem on Domlivo](#): 79 flats, median €1,311/m².

Mali i Robit and Qerret. South of Golem. Mali i Robit is the quieter, cheaper end: €950–1,200/m² (homezone.al), new builds such as Vision 3 at €1,090–1,164/m². Qerret is the fastest-rising zone of the

whole coast, +21–43% year on year (monitor.al): €1,100–1,500/m² behind the villas, €1,700–2,000 near the sea, €2,200–2,500 on the first line, with a strong Polish, Czech and Hungarian following. [Mali i Robit](#): 19 flats, median €1,500/m². [Qerret](#): 12 flats, median €1,300/m².

Bay of Lalëz (Gjiri i Lalzit). North of the city: gated resorts (Lura, San Pietro, Vala Mar) at €2,500–3,500/m² for the luxury tier and €1,500–1,700 on the second line and early-stage projects; townhouses €600–850k, villas up to €3 million on the first line (monitor.al). Buyers are the diaspora in Germany, Switzerland and the US and wealthy Kosovars. Domlivo has too few listings here for a median.

Budget inland: Spitalë, Kënetë, Xhafzotaj, Shkozet. €500–1,400/m², old stock under €800 (Investropa), with prices flat for years; the research base's working band for Shkozet is €600–900/m². Shkozet sits on the rail corridor, which is the one argument for it.

Asking prices today

Sale listings on Domlivo, September 20, 2026: 358 in the Durrës area, of which 268 flats. These are asking prices; the Bank of Albania's agent survey says more than half of sales close at asking or up to 5% below, and coastal time-to-sell is about ten months.

	Flats	From	Median price	Median €/m ²
Durrës, all	268	€40,000	€100,000	1,413
Studios	23	€45,000	€58,680	1,500
1+1 (one bedroom)	151	€55,000	€90,000	1,416
2+1 (two bedrooms)	73	€40,000	€135,000	1,444
3+1	11	€118,000	€150,000	1,119
Within 300 m of the sea	89	€50,000	€105,000	1,400
New builds and off-plan	45	€59,360	€83,300	1,250

District	Flats	From	Median price	Median €/m ²
Golem	79	€50,000	€88,000	1,311
Plazh	66	€45,000	€115,000	1,588
City Centre	46	€75,000	€140,000	1,500
Shkëmbi i Kavajës	30	€50,000	€82,000	1,471
Mali i Robit	19	€68,000	€87,000	1,500
Qerret	12	€83,200	€85,000	1,300
Plepa	7	€65,000	€90,000	1,625

Of the 210 flats with a total price, 6.2% ask under €60,000, 43.3% €60,000–100,000, 32.4% €100,000–150,000 and 18.1% more. For context, Deloitte's 2024 average for new dwellings in Durrës was €1,350/m², and the Bank of Albania's national index rose 28% in the second half of 2025, driven by the coast.

Medians are taken over flats and studios only, at the price the seller asks. A listing priced per m² counts at its rate. Small samples (Plepa, Spille) move with a single listing.

What buying costs on top of the price

Apartment sales in Albania are VAT-exempt, so a new build carries no extra 20%. The buyer's own costs are small; what varies is who ends up paying the 2% transfer tax and whether you hire a lawyer.

Item	Amount	Who pays	Source and confidence
Notary fee	0.23–0.35% of the contract value, by band (0.35% up to 6 million lek, 0.30% to 15 million, 0.28% to 50 million)	buyer, by custom	Ministry of Justice Order 279/2012 · medium (whether bands are marginal is open)
VAT on the notary fee	+20% of the fee if the notary is VAT-registered	buyer	VAT law · low
Notary stamp	1,000 lek (≈ €11) per contract	buyer	PwC tax summary · medium
Cadastre (ASHK) registration	3,500 lek (≈ €38); older sources say 5,000 lek	buyer	Instruction 29/2018 · medium
ASHK one-stop fees via the notary	≈ 5,300 lek (≈ €58): application, status check, property card	buyer	notary tariff · medium
Transfer tax	2% of the value, not below the zone reference	the seller by law; often shifted to the buyer by contract	Law 9632/2006 · medium-high on the rate, open on who pays
Agency commission	0–1% buyer side (some agencies 0%, up to 2% reported); the seller pays 3%	buyer	published agency schedules · medium
Lawyer, due diligence	€500–2,000	buyer, optional but recommended	practice · low-medium
Sworn translator	€50–150	buyer; mandatory if you do not understand Albanian	Notary Law 110/2018 · medium
Power of attorney	€30–150 if someone signs for you	buyer, optional	estimate · low
Bank transfer and FX	€50–200; 0.5–1.5% spread if you convert to lek	buyer	bank tariffs · low

At the current Domlivo median of €100,000, the fees the site's calculator charges — notary €300, registration €38, a 1% buyer's commission €1,000 — come to about €1,338, or 1.3% of the price. The research base's worked example for a €100,000 flat lands at about 2.5% in the typical case (adds a translator and a lawyer), 0.5% at the minimum, and up to 5.5% if the transfer tax is shifted to you — 8.5% only with a large FX spread and full legal support. Budget 3–4% and you will not be surprised.

Two things to fix in writing before you pay a deposit: who pays the 2% transfer tax, and whether the price is "me TVSH apo pa TVSH" (with or without VAT). Both are contract terms, not law.

The purchase, step by step

Foreigners buy flats, houses and commercial property on the same terms as Albanian citizens, including inheritance; only agricultural land is excluded (an Albanian company or a lease of up to 99 years are the usual routes). No residence permit, tax number or local bank account is needed for the purchase itself — you can wire the price from abroad to the notary's escrow account.

1. **Reservation.** A deposit ("kaparë") of 5–10%, up to 30% on new builds, deducted from the price. Get the refund terms in writing; a reservation that is not refundable if the build stops has cost buyers €20,000 before.
2. **Due diligence, 1–2 weeks.** The property card ("kartela e pasurisë"), the encumbrance extract, the cadastral map ("harta treguese"), 30+ years of title history, the building permit ("leje ndërtimi") and the certificate of use ("leje përdorimi"). A lawyer is not required by law and is the only real protection — there is no title insurance in Albania, and a first-instance court case takes about a year, an appeal several.
3. **Preliminary contract.** For a finished home, a notarised pre-contract. For a new build, only a notarised purchase-order contract ("kontratë porosie") registered with ASHK protects you from the same unit being sold twice; a private contract is void for transfers.
4. **The notarial deed, one day.** Ownership passes only by notarial deed. The price goes through the notary's escrow account (the notary cannot handle cash above 150,000 lek); the notary withholds the taxes and, if you do not speak Albanian, a sworn translator reads the deed and co-signs it.
5. **Registration with ASHK.** Filed by the notary, no visit needed; officially 21 days, in practice 2–4 weeks, months for a complicated title. You then receive the new property card in your name.

With clean papers the whole cycle takes 4–8 weeks. A mortgage from an Albanian bank is close to unavailable to a non-resident without local income; developers' interest-free instalment plans until handover are the common alternative on new builds.

Documents to bring

- Passport (the number is recorded at ASHK).
- A sworn translator if you do not understand Albanian — arranged by the notary, paid by you.
- A notarised power of attorney only if someone signs for you; issued abroad, it needs an apostille (Albania joined the Apostille Convention in 2004) and an Albanian translation.
- A marriage or civil-status certificate: the deed states your marital property regime.
- Proof of the bank transfer of the price; the notary may ask for proof of funds under anti-money-laundering rules.
- An Albanian tax number is on many agencies' lists but not required for individuals by the official sources found; you will need one later, through a representative, to declare rental income.

Checks that stop the usual failures

- **Is it registered at all?** About a tenth of the country's territory is unregistered; ask for the kartela before anything else.

- **Legalised self-build ("leje legalizimi").** The title is real, but compensation to the former landowner may be unpaid — a ground for challenge.
- **The developer's mortgage.** A bank charge on the plot passes to the units: ask for the encumbrance extract of the parent plot, not just the flat.
- **Extra floors and changed layouts.** Since ASHK Instruction 1557/2024 a mismatch between the built plan and the permit means registration is refused; compare the flat with the approved plan before paying.
- **Utility debts follow the meter.** Certificates from OSHEE (electricity), the water utility and the building administrator.
- **Year of construction and seismic standard,** especially in Plazh and Shkëmbi i Kavajës, where buildings fell in 2019.
- **The "local way".** Under-declaring the price in the deed saves the seller tax and leaves you unable to prove what you paid; one contract, one bank transfer.

What owning costs per year

- **Property tax.** Currently 0.05% a year of the fiscal value (the state reference price per m² times the area), for residential property. Durrës still applies a single city-wide reference from 2016 — sources give 67,500 or 71,200 lek/m² (monitor.al; Homezone) — so a 60 m² flat pays roughly 2,000–2,150 lek a year, about €22–23. A reform to 0.1–0.2% of market value, with a 50% first-home relief and higher rates for flats let short-term, was in consultation in mid-2026 and would apply from 2029; it is not enacted.
- **Electricity.** 10.2 lek/kWh incl. VAT up to 700 kWh a month, 11.4 on the whole month above that (ERE Decision 322, valid for 2026). The average household uses about 230 kWh a month, some 2,350 lek (≈ €25); summer air-conditioning and winter heating are what push a beach flat over that.
- **Water.** Durrës has the most expensive water in the country: 70 lek/m³ water plus 50 lek/m³ sewerage plus a 200 lek monthly fee in the city and Plazh; the Kavajë unit (Golem, Qerret, Mali i Robit) charges 50 + 30 + 200. The regulator's benchmark bill for 5 m³ is 800 lek in Durrës. Supply runs about 13 hours a day, which is why every building has a roof tank and a pump.
- **Building fee.** 1,000–1,500 lek a month in a post-1993 building with a lift, up to 3,000 in premium blocks; old blocks 400–500 (Law 55/2025 makes the administration fee mandatory). Resort complexes with pools and security publish nothing reliable — expect several times more.
- **Waste.** Durrës has not published its 2026 tariff; by analogy with Vlorë and Sarandë, 3,000–4,000 lek a year.
- **Insurance.** From 5,000 lek a year (≈ €54), roughly €1–1.5 per m²; banks require it with a mortgage, and after 2019 it is worth having anyway.
- **Internet.** About 1,690 lek a month. The heating season runs from mid-November to mid-March.
- **If you let.** Individuals pay a flat 15% on rental income, declared annually in DIVA by 31 March; short lets through platforms are taxed on the amount after the platform's commission, with no other deductions, and need no business registration. Non-residents pay the same and get a credit at home under one of Albania's roughly 46 double-tax treaties. On resale, capital gains are taxed at 15%.

Questions to ask the seller

1. Can I see the current property card (kartela) and the encumbrance extract — for the flat and for the plot?
2. Does the building have a building permit and a certificate of use, and does the built layout match the approved plan?
3. What year was it built, and to which seismic standard? What was repaired after November 2019?
4. How did you acquire the title — purchase, legalisation, inheritance — and is any restitution claim known?
5. Are there unpaid electricity, water or building-fee bills?
6. What is the monthly building fee, who administers the building, and is there a pool or security to pay for?
7. Will the price in the deed be the full price I pay?
8. Is the price with or without VAT, and who pays the 2% transfer tax?
9. For a new build: will the purchase-order contract be notarised and registered at ASHK, what is the payment schedule, what happens if handover is late, and is the plot mortgaged?
10. How many hours a day does the water run, and is there a tank and pump? How far is the sea, and (in Golem) which sewer line serves the building?

Talk to Domlivo

Domlivo lists property across Albania in seven languages, with the same asking-price statistics this guide uses, updated with every listing. If you want a shortlist in Durrës that fits a budget, or a second opinion on a flat you have found elsewhere, write to us in your language.

- WhatsApp: wa.me/message/KPXIGD5DJISGO1
- Telegram: t.me/real_estate_al
- Email: hello@domlivo.com
- All Durrës listings: domlivo.com/en/albania/durres

Sources

Domlivo listings (September 20, 2026); Bank of Albania real-estate survey H2 2025; Deloitte Property Index 2024; monitor.al (April 2026 coast survey; July 2026 on reference prices); Investropa; indomio.al; homezone.al; Ministry of Justice Order 279/2012 on notary tariffs; Law 110/2018 on the notary; Law 9632/2006 on local taxes; Law 29/2023 on income tax; ASHK Instruction 1557/2024; ERE Decision 322/2025 (electricity); ERRU tariff table January 2026 (water); Law 55/2025 on co-ownership; PwC Albania tax summaries; HLB Albania on the 2026 short-let regime. Confidence notes follow the Domlivo research base; items marked "open" await verification by an Albanian lawyer.